FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-25-18002

Issue Title : Rockwell Collins Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Latch

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	2540-00	-8, -9
Other Model(s)	**ECCN**	
737NG	9E991	

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
09/28/2018	04/01/2020	03/27/2020
Estimated Completion Date	**Next Update Date**	
06/23/2020	05/26/2020	

Revision Description

-Updated Final Action with release of Boeing Service Letter Revision A

-Revised Boeing Service Letter to Revision A in References

-Updated Milestones to reflect the release of Boeing Service Letter Revision A

-Updated Status to include possible regulatory action.

Applicability

Airplanes with Collins Aerospace (formerly Rockwell Collins) lavatories with bi-fold doors. The bi-fold doors are an optional selection for the lavatories that are on the aft of the airplane and the first bi-fold door was delivered on L/N 6184 (Dec 2016).

See attached list for identification of airplanes delivered with the impacted bi-fold door as of September 2018.

Description

A 737 MAX operator reported a Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Lock Dual Latch (P/N SC1L500031-3/-4/-5/-6) failure during flight. This resulted in the bi-fold door lock mechanism becoming inoperative. In this failure mode, both the latch knob inside the lavatory and the override mechanism outside the lavatory could be moved freely between the locked and un-locked position without disengaging the lock bolt. The cabin crew were unable to open the lavatory door from the outside and the passenger was not able to open the door from the inside. The passenger remained inside the lavatory during landing.

Upon arrival, maintenance personnel found the locking pin stuck in the 'locked' position. Maintenance was able to open the door and release the passenger.

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The amount of time a passenger would spend in a lavatory with a broken latch can be significantly reduced if the cabin crew is aware of methods to unlock the door using commonly available items.

A second failure during flight has been reported by a 737NG operator using the same Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Lock Dual Latch (P/N SC1L500031-3/-4/-5/-6). This resulted in the bi-fold door lock mechanism becoming inoperative. The cabin crew were unable to open the lavatory door from the outside and the passenger was unable to open the door from the inside. The passenger remained inside the lavatory during landing.

Status

Boeing analysis of the returned broken sliding bolt from the operator, concluded that the root cause of the shearing of the internal sliding bolt to be material fatigue, due primarily to the excessive stress combined with weld-line, and machining marks at the location of the ball-plunger.

Boeing has opened a Service Related Problem (SRP) project after the report of a second operator reporting a latch failure.

Boeing understands that the FAA is reviewing this issue for possible regulatory action.

Interim Action

Boeing and Collins Aerospace are providing guidance to operators to open a Rockwell Collins Bi-Fold Door (P/N 1L460038-XXX) in the event the Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Lock Dual Latch (P/N SC1L500031-3/-4/-5/-6) becomes inoperative. Using this guidance, the onboard cabin crew will be able to release a broken door lock within minutes.

Please review 'Bi-Fold Alternative Opening Methods' attachment which contains guidance that on-board cabin crew can use to release a broken Bi-fold door lock.

Please note that prior to following the instructions listed in the 'Bi-Fold Alternative Opening Methods' attachment, the cabin crew must first attempt to open the door per the standard operating instructions listed in document SIL SL-1L3-25-0007 to ensure the door lock is truly malfunctioning.

At the next convenient maintenance opportunity, inspect the Lav Bi-Fold Door Lock Mechanism for any signs of cracks. Please review Collins Aerospace SIL SL-1L3-25-0022 for inspection instructions.

Final Action

Collins Aerospace (formerly Rockwell Collins) released Service Bulletin 1L3-25-0069 to provide instructions for operators to remove and replace Bi-Fold Door Lock – Dual Vertical Bolt Indicator P/N SC1L500031-3/-4/-5/-6 with new P/N SC1L500031-9/10.

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Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-25-171 advises operators to replace the Bi-Fold Door Lock per the Collins Aerospace service bulletin at a convenient maintenance opportunity.

The new Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Lock was incorporated into production starting with Line Number 7403 for airplanes with the bi-fold door option installed.

Collins Aerospace updated the service bulletin to change the Compliance Recommendation and considers this a MANDATORY Service Bulletin that must be accomplished within four (4) months of release of Revision A 21-Oct-2019.

Boeing Service Letter 737-SL-25-171 Revision A was released on 25-Mar-2020 to advise operators of the new Compliance Recommendation from Collins Aerospace

Milestones

Note: Target dates are based upon currently available status and have risk of future revision.

Root Cause Established: 01-Nov-2018 (complete)

Solution Selected: 01-Nov-2018 (complete)

Supplier Service Bulletin Available: 28-Jan-2019 (complete)

Production Incorporation: Feb 2019 (complete)

Boeing Service Letter Available: 27-Feb-2019 (complete)

Supplier Service Bulletin Rev A Available: 21-Oct-2019 (complete)

Revised Boeing Service Letter : 25-Mar-2019 (complete)

Supplier Information

Collins Aerospace (formerly Rockwell Collins)

Advanced Lavatories & Cabin Interiors

11404 Commando Road, Suite B

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Everett, Washington 98204

Cage Code: 6S8D7

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Service Letter (SL)	Collins Aerospace SL-1L3-25-0007		
Service Bulletin (SB)	Collins Aerospace SB 1L3-25-0069	A	10/21/2019
Service Letter (SL)	Collins Aerospace SL-1L3-25-0022		
Multi-Operator Message (MOM)	MOM-MOM-18-0593-01B		10/05/2018
Service Letter (SL)	737-SL-25-171	A	03/25/2020
Service Related Problem (SRP)	737MAX-SRP-25-0417		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Lavatory Bi-Fold Door		Collins Aerospace (formerly Rockwell Collins)	1L460038-XXX
Lavatory Bi-Fold Door Lock Dual Latch		Collins Aerospace (formerly Rockwell Collins)	SC1L500031-XX

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability

Attachments:

a) Airplane Deliveries with Bi-Fold Doors v2

b) Bi-Fold Door Alternative Opening Methods

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